NeuroTech

Summer Programs

Materials

Disclaimer

There is no perfect method for applying to summer opportunities!

Suggestion: Try to discover on your own and fill in the gaps with these resources

Game Plan

No lab experience

- Interesting REUs
- Cold email a UIUC lab

With lab experience

- Targeted REUs
- Apply for UIUC grants

Example: NSF ETAP EDUCATION & TRAINING APPLICATION

My Experiences

No lab experience

- Interesting REUs
- Cold email a UIUC lab

With lab experience

- Targeted REUs
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Personal Statement

- Start early!!
- Every program has different requirements
  - Statement about PhD
- Include specific professors/labs
- ~This is the only program I'm applying to~
- Have friends, graduates read your statement
  - Speed read
  - Slow read
- Align with your CV/Resume

Industry Example

- LinkedIn job alerts
- Search specific companies
- Apply as soon as it opens

Research Intern

PhD

NSF ETAP

- An application portal for REUs funded by NSF (National Science Foundation)
- (1-2) References only have to upload rec letter once
  - Easier for you to apply to as many REUs as you can/want
- Each application requires transcript, resume, 1-2 LoR, personal statement, ocassionally additional questions
- Submit early!! Website is prone to crashing from heavy traffic...
  - If it crashes, it’s a gamble whether you can submit your application on time

Resume

- 1 page, ATS-friendly, clean
- Tailor for each role through rewording / change of emphasis
- Quantify your impact and highlight the relevant skills (Python, CAD, Leadership, etc.)
- Use action verbs (everyone says this but it’s true!)
- Show a clear focus of your experiences - show how they have prepared you for a specific career path/role
    - Avoid looking too spread out if possible